

Exhibition Today; Dudley Dressed Up For Opener

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The start of the Texas League season is only two days away, but El Paso Diablo general manager Jim Paul is still as busy as he was at the opening of the season ticket campaign a month and a half ago.

As the ballclub drifted into town for Wednesday's Press Day exhibition against the University of Texas at El Paso, Paul was finalizing plans for this weekend's

opening series against the Amarillo Giants at Dudley Field.

The opener Friday night will be promoted as just that, with fans getting their first look at 14 players new to El Paso, restyled uniforms, and a resprucing job on Dudley it self.

The ballpark will have new lighting for the 69-game TL schedule with lower voltage bulbs that will increase candlepower by some 30 per cent without using extra elec-

tricity.

The fence has been repainted, and the field itself is in better condition than anytime in the last three years.

Then Saturday, the first 1,000 youngsters into the park will receive Diablo kites. Sunday's 2 p.m. doubleheader will feature a world's record banana split between games.

That banana split will be 105 feet long, containing 179 bananas, 15 gallons of ice cream, 12 gallons each of strawberries, chocolate and

pineapple topping and 252 ounces of whipped cream.

The bananas will be from Jaquez Produce with Price's Creameries supplying the ice cream.

As for the sales campaign itself, Paul calls the advance "easily the best for El Paso in 10, 11 years."

All 48 fence signs have been sold, and the games will be on radio again after a one year absence.

As for season tickets, 238 box seats and 36 season reserved seats have

been sold. Revenues from general admission ticketbooks is expected to surpass \$10,000 before the season is over.

Paul, however, is hoping the team itself will be the biggest draw. The Miner exhibition Wednesday is scheduled for 2 p.m., with KTEP-FM's broadcast to start at 1:40.

The club's first workout in Dudley was Tuesday evening. Manager Dave Garcia led the Rojos through a two-hour practice session after a

short team meeting.

Garcia didn't name a starter for the Wednesday game, just saying that several pitchers would get in some work.

Mike Kruta has drawn Coach Andy Cohen's call as the Miner starter in the tilt, first ever between the city's college and professional teams.

Frank Kenyon has already been selected by Garcia to start against the Giants Friday.